

Saikou Ira — Supernatural Investigator

Kahfagian Marine Captain turned Occult Detective of The Witness

Profile

Name: Saikou Ira
Concept: Kahfagian Marine Captain turned Supernatural Investigator
Tier: IV
Affiliation: Kahfagian Navy, The Witness, The Empty Temple
Familiar: Nyx — spirit cat, bound through mirror rite

Main Patron: The Witness, Keeper of the Unblinking Truth. Its symbol is a silver mirror set in obsidian: always clear of dust, never reflecting the caster. Those who serve The Witness walk a razor's edge between revelation and ruin.

Attributes

Body 2 — disciplined but scarred
Wits 4 — tactical intellect, forensic insight
Spirit 3 — steeled will, supernatural focus
Presence 3 — commanding voice, analytical calm

Skills

Investigation 4; Arcana 3; Command 2; Sway 3; Lore 2; Melee 2

Talents

- **Caster's Gift** — Freeform ritual casting guided by The Witness.
- **Thiasos (Nyx)** — Spirit Familiar capable of passing through reflections, sensing lies, and retrieving echoes of truth.
- **Codex** — The Witness' Runekeeper compendium; each rune is a truth etched in reflection.
- **Patron's Symbols** — Divination (Truth), Abjuration (Wards), Exorcism (Banishment), Kahfagian Heritage (Raéyn's favor).
- **Lorekeeper** — Recall obscure knowledge without rolling; The Witness whispers forgotten details.
- **Exceptional Coordination** — One follower provides +4 Assist dice.
- **Iron Stomach** — Immune to mundane toxins; truth cannot be poisoned.
- **Mirror Axiom (Tier IV)** — *1/scene*, declare you prepared a reflective record earlier (flashback at 0 Stress if plausible). Create a durable *Evidence (Truth)* asset and gain +1 Effect on the current Investigate/Analyze action.
- **Cross-Examination (Tier IV)** — When you reveal a direct contradiction in testimony or scene facts, either lower the opposing DV by 1 *or* improve your Position by one step for the next roll in that exchange.

Patron — The Witness

Symbol: A silver mirror on obsidian base.

Domain: Investigation, revelation, clarity through confrontation.

Epithets: The Unblinking Eye, The Mirror Without Reflection, Judge of Lies.

Doctrine: “There is no mercy in truth, but neither is there falsehood in justice.”

Rites:

- **Rite of the Lingering Glimpse (Low)** — Preserve a fading truth long enough to analyze; requires a reflective surface.
- **Rite of Piercing Scrutiny (Low)** — Read falsehood from the eyes or aura of a speaker.
- **Rite of the Echoing Truth (Standard)** — Manifest spoken truths as visible runes that linger briefly.
- **Rite of the Immutable Record (Standard)** — Inscribe an event into mirror or lens; cannot be erased.

Familiar — Nyx

A sleek black cat with heterochromia. Bound spirit of The Witness, serving as mirror and messenger.

Abilities:

- Detect auras and falsehoods.
- Slip through reflections and polished metal.
- Telepathic link to Saikou; transfers whispers and visions.
- Retrieve “echoes of truth” from a crime scene, granting Saikou +1 die on the next Investigation roll.

Personality: Sarcastic, watchful, unerring loyalty to the mirror law. *Bond:* “Truth hides in the dark, Captain. Let me bring the light that burns it clean.”

Follower — Amari, Kahfagian Marine Bodyguard

Tier: III Follower (3–5 Cap)

Role: Protective shadow and shock infantry guard.

Traits: Disciplined, vigilant, unshakably loyal to Saikou and the old Navy codes.

Loadout: Reinforced boarding shields, barbed spear, storm-blue cloak, iron lantern.

Special: Combat Boarding Specialist

- **Spear-and-Shield Blitz:** When Amari Charges a target within Near range, roll Melee. On a success, choose two:
 - Knock the target Prone.
 - Pin the target against cover or a wall.
 - Disarm a held weapon.

- Advance Saikou into a better Position (e.g., Controlled → Dominant).

On a Partial, choose one and Amari risks Level 1 Harm.

Harm & Morale:

- **Wounded:** -1 die to Athletics and Melee.
- **Broken Shield:** First time Level 2 Harm is taken, her shield splinters. She keeps fighting with spear alone.
- **Level 3 Harm:** Amari is incapacitated and Saikou gains +2 Boons to spend this scene.
- **If not recovered in 3 days:** Her Morale turns—she becomes obsessed with protecting Saikou, even at the cost of others.

Bond Move — “Not Again.”

When Amari takes Harm *for* Saikou, Saikou gains +1 die to the next Resolve or Investigation roll against fear, illusions, or mind-affecting magic. If Saikou Pushes that roll, add +2 dice instead.

Ouroboros Tattoo (Debt Mark):

A serpent eating its tail, inked in silver along Amari’s shoulder. Once per session, when Saikou gives an order that protects the innocent or reveals a hidden truth, Amari may refresh 1 Harm box or stand back up at Level 2 Harm for one more exchange before collapsing.

Sidebar: Investigation Techniques

- **The Canré Method (3 Moves Ahead):** Frame three hypotheses; sacrifice one each scene to force revelation. Spend 1 Boon to reposition socially after a risky reveal.
- **Lantern Pier Routine:** Log smell, sound, light, line before touching evidence. Once per case, recall one and gain +1 die.
- **Evidence Ladder:** Always convert one clue into an *asset*—map-pin, oath, witness favor.
- **Ritual Forensics:** Pair Witness + Sealed Gate: reveal, then sanctify. Contamination attempts are Desperate.
- **Interview Triangulation:** Factual, motive, memory—each in separate locales. Contradictions = actionable leads.
- **Harbor Net (Kahfagia):** Spend 1 Boon to “buy the tide” for quiet access to a restricted quay.
- **Shadow Walk:** Move one block ahead; predict choices. Place a Waymark +1 die to ambush.

Recovery Scene — The Lantern and the Sea

When tending Amari’s wounds, narrate a calm reflection. If Saikou speaks a hard truth aloud, remove 1 Level of Harm from Amari. If Saikou remains silent, Saikou instead clears 1 Stress.

Sidebar: Patron Interaction Reference

The Witness — Truth/Revelation

Invoke: First pass on a scene; deciding what’s real.

Spend: 1 Boon to stabilize a fragile vision.

Conflict Sign: Mirrors film over.

Whisper: “Ask the question that costs a friend.”

Overuse: Cold judgment—1 die to warmth/comfort until rest.

The Sealed Gate — Boundaries/Closure

Invoke: When harm spreads: contagion, panic, spirits.

Spend: 1 Boon to anchor a ward to a *name*.

Conflict Sign: Doors refuse to open twice.

Overuse: Collateral isolation.

Raéyn — Storms/Tides

Invoke: Momentum shifts, maritime leads, crowd control.

Spend: 1 Boon to reposition the team without provoking.

Conflict Sign: Salt taste; floor tilts.

Overuse: Tempers flare—parley starts at worse Position.

The Traveler — Ways/Roads

Invoke: Escapes, tails, pattern pursuit.

Spend: 1 Boon to turn a Waymark into a safe escape route.

Conflict Sign: Maps smudge at the margins.

Overuse: Timing slips—an ally arrives a scene late.

GM Note: If two Patrons are invoked in the same exchange, consider a brief interference: a sign, a complication, or a minor cost. Success should still stand.